Billing and Payments: User Guide

HMS · Standard Staff Operational Manual · Updated October 2026

In one sentence: The OPD desk, the lab counter and the pharmacy POS each manage their own billing and payments without double-counting. Clinic owners, managers, cashiers and accountants monitor the entire money lifecycle in one place through **Billing › Dashboard**, **Billing › Payments** and **Billing › Outstanding**.

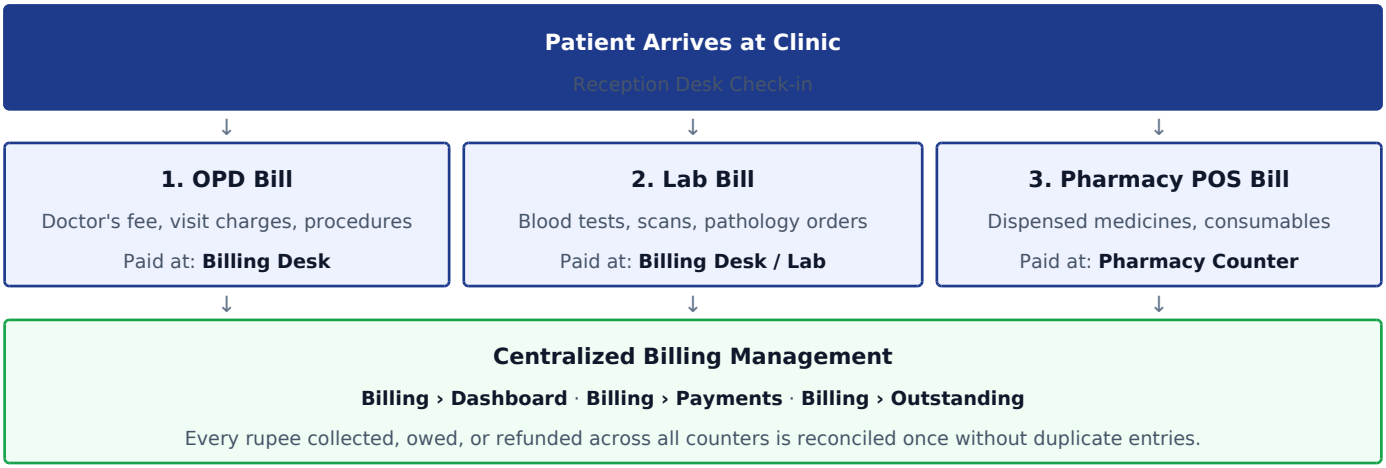
Guide Table of Contents

#	Working Flow Section	Key Topic Covered	Target Audience
1	The Big Picture & 3 Counters	OPD, Lab & Pharmacy separation, unified reporting	All Staff
2	Roles & Permissions	Who can view, create, edit, collect and refund	Owner, Admin
3	First-Time Setup	Prefixes, payment rules, GST/tax, services & prices	Owner, Manager
4	OPD Working Flow	Check-in → Doctor consult → Bill → Payment → Receipt	Reception, Cashier, Doctor
5	The Billing Dashboard	Top 4 KPIs, Revenue trend, Services donut, Invoices table	Owner, Accountant, Manager
6	Taking Payments & Split Tenders	Pay in Full, Partial, Credit, split cash + UPI + card	Cashier, Receptionist
7	Outstanding Invoices & Aging	Tracking debt, aging buckets (0–30, 31–60, 90+ days), recovery	Cashier, Accountant
8	Payments Register & Day-End Close	Payment ledger, tender breakdown, cashier drawer reconciliation	Cashier, Accountant
9	Laboratory Orders & Billing	Test pricing, automated billing, payment verification	Lab Staff, Cashier
10	Pharmacy Counter & POS Sales	Counter sales, batch FIFO, credit balances, medicine returns	Pharmacist
11	Refunds, Corrections & Cancelling	Refund slips (`RFD`), editing rules, cancellation audit	Cashier, Manager
12	Troubleshooting Guide	Common error messages and their immediate solutions	All Staff
13	Screen Navigation Directory	Exact menu paths for every operational task	All Staff

1. The Big Picture: How Clinic Billing Works

In HMS, one patient visit can generate up to three independent bills. Each bill belongs strictly to its department counter so that responsibilities and stock remain clean:

FLOW CHART 1 · THE THREE BILLING COUNTERS AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCE



Department	What is billed	Trigger Timing Options	Counter Responsible
OPD	Consultation fee, follow-up, dressing, ECG, nursing charge	At check-in, after consultation, or on manual desk click	Reception / Billing counter
Laboratory	Ordered tests, profiles, panels, pathology tests	When tests ordered, or after lab results sign-off	Billing desk or Lab counter
Pharmacy	Dispensed medicines, surgicals, retail health items	At the moment of counter dispensing (POS)	Pharmacy counter directly

2. Who Can Do What (Roles & Access)

Access is managed in **Roles & Permissions**. Each clinic role has specific permissions configured:

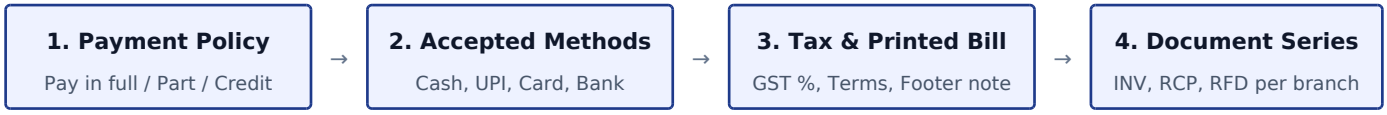
Role	Primary Capabilities	Billing Permissions Needed
Receptionist / Cashier	Check in patients, create manual bills, record payments, print receipts	`View invoices and payments`, `Record a payment`
Doctor	Conduct consultations, order lab tests, prescribe medicines, add procedures	`Start/complete consultations`, `Order lab tests`
Pharmacist	Dispense medicines, collect counter sales, manage batch returns	`Sell at counter`, `Cancel pharmacy bill/return`
Accountant / Manager	Audit collections, manage refunds, correct unpaid bills, export registers	`Create invoices`, `Edit before payment`, `Refund payment`, `Cancel invoice`
Owner / Admin	Overall clinic finance, change payment policies, branch series, doctor fees	`Full administrative access`

Important for Reception Desks: If your clinic collects consultation fees upfront at check-in, ensure the Receptionist role has both **View invoices and payments** and **Record a payment** switched on. Otherwise, the bill will generate but the desk cannot record the money.

3. First-Time Setup (Settings › Billing)

Before issuing real bills, configure clinic billing parameters once under **Settings › Billing**:

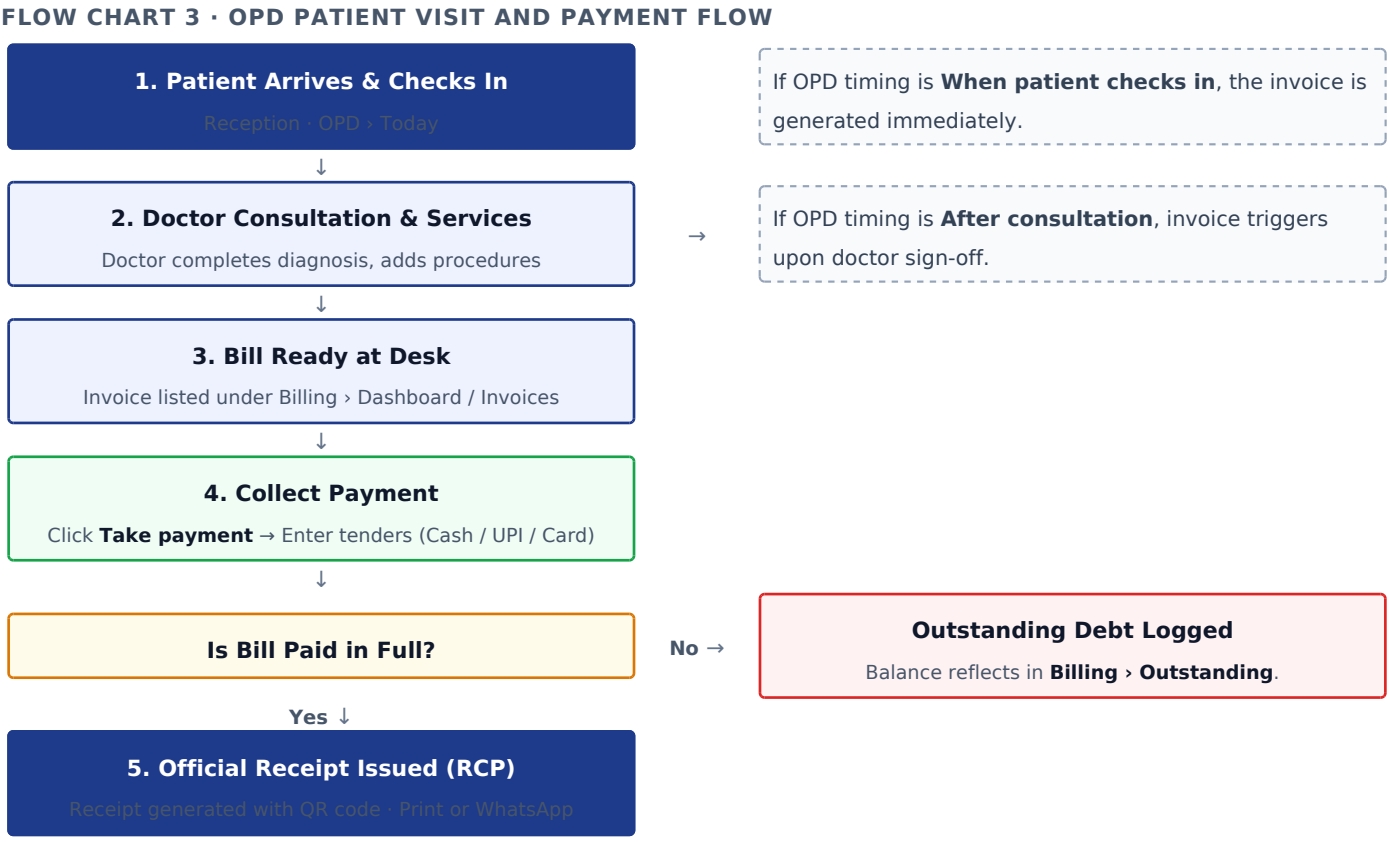
FLOW CHART 2 · FIRST-TIME CLINIC BILLING CONFIGURATION



1. **Payment Policy:** Choose **Pay in full** (recommended for standard OPD), **Part payment allowed** (for procedures/instalments), or **Pay later (credit)** (allows registered patients to carry balances).
2. **Payment Methods:** Enable the payment modes accepted at your counter: **Cash**, **UPI**, **Credit/Debit Card**, **Bank Transfer**, **Cheque**.
3. **Document Number Series:** Customize official numbering prefixes per branch (e.g. `GKP/INV/26-27/00001` for invoices, `GKP/RCP/26-27/00001` for receipts, `GKP/RFD/26-27/00001` for refund vouchers). All sequences automatically restart each financial year on 1 April.
4. **Department Timing:** Specify when OPD bills trigger (e.g. **After consultation**) and when Lab bills trigger (e.g. **When tests ordered**).
5. **Services & Pricing:** In **Billing › Services & Prices** and Doctor profiles, set doctor consultation fees, follow-up rules, registration fees, and nursing/procedure charges.

4. OPD Working Flow: Check-in to Receipt

The standard lifecycle of an OPD patient visit and its billing:



5. The Billing Dashboard (`/billing`)

The primary control center for monitoring clinic revenue, billing performance, and operational invoices:

TOTAL INVOICES	TOTAL BILLED	OUTSTANDING	COLLECTED
124	**₹1,24,850**	**₹18,450**	**₹1,06,400**
+12% vs last month · Month: 28	+8% vs last month · Month: ₹32,400	12 invoices awaiting recovery	112 invoices fully settled

Middle Analytics Row

- **Revenue Trend:** Multi-series bar and line chart displaying Billed revenue (blue bars) against Collections (green line) across customizable daily, weekly, or monthly timeframes. Hovering reveals day-by-day totals.
- **Collection by Service:** Donut chart showing exact revenue distribution across clinic service lines: **Consultation (OPD)**, **Lab Tests**, **Pharmacy**, **Procedures**, and **Others**, complete with percentage share and rupee values.
- **Payment Status:** Donut breakdown of invoice states: **Paid**, **Part Paid**, and **Unpaid**.

Invoices Register & Quick Tabs

Directly beneath the analytics cards is the interactive invoice ledger with 5 filter tabs:

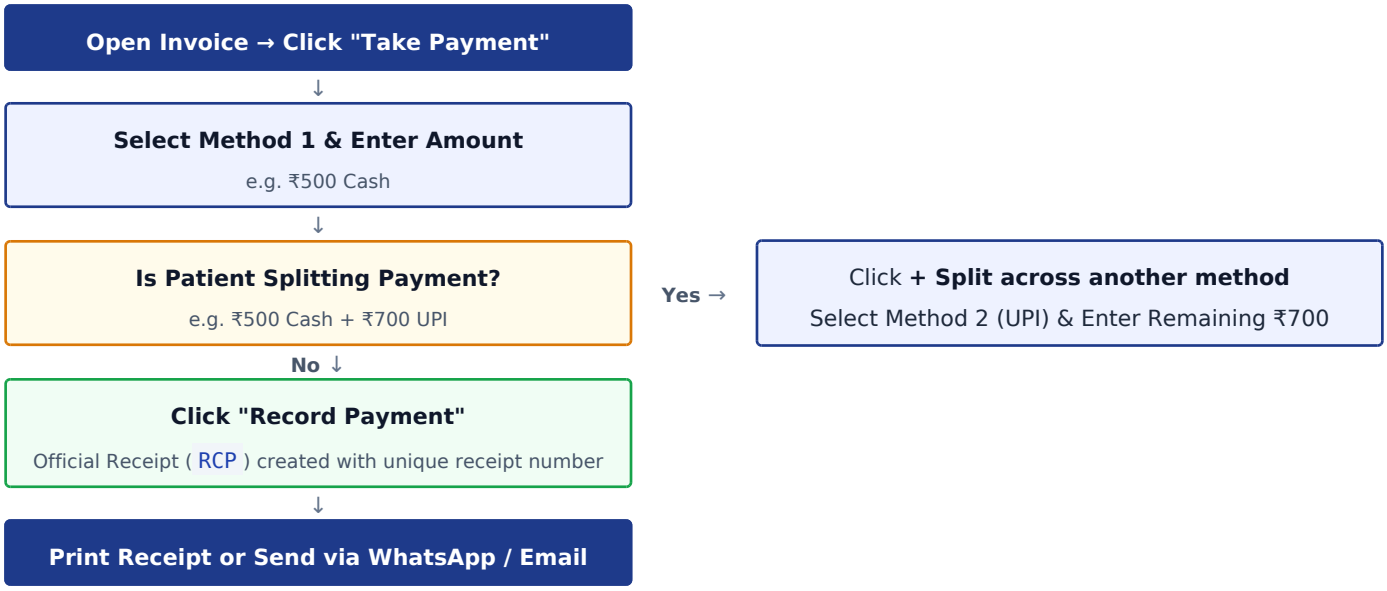
- **All Invoices:** Complete chronological register of all invoices raised in the selected date window.
- **Outstanding:** Only invoices with unpaid balances requiring cashier follow-up.
- **Open Visits:** Draft bills still collecting procedure or consultation charges while the patient is in the clinic.
- **Paid:** Fully cleared invoices with zero balance.

- **Cancelled:** Invoices voided before payment or fully refunded.

6. Taking Payments & Split Tenders

When taking payments at the desk, HMS provides full support for single and split payment methods:

FLOW CHART 4 · CASHIER PAYMENT COLLECTION & SPLIT TENDER FLOW



Split Tender Example

A bill of ₹1,200 is settled with ₹500 in cash and ₹700 via GooglePay UPI. The cashier adds both lines in the payment popup. The system generates one unified receipt `GKP/RCP/26-27/00045` documenting both tenders for auditing.

Double-Click Protection: The payment dialog generates a unique transaction signature. If a cashier clicks "Record Payment" twice or network flickers, the system detects the signature and executes the transaction only once. Money is never double-charged.

7. Outstanding Invoices & Debt Recovery (`/billing/outstanding`)

The dedicated recovery dashboard for tracking unpaid balances and credit accounts:

TOTAL OUTSTANDING	PENDING INVOICES	UNPAID INVOICES	PARTIALLY PAID
₹1,750.00	**4**	**2**	**2**
Across 4 active invoices	Invoices awaiting balance	Total unpaid: ₹1,100.00	Total balance: ₹650.00

Aging Filter & Overdue Days

Staff can filter outstanding accounts by age to prioritize recovery:

- **0–30 Days:** Current month visits. Normal grace period.
- **31–60 Days:** Follow-up required via WhatsApp reminder or phone call.
- **61–90 Days:** Overdue balances. Requires manager intervention before scheduling new appointments.
- **90+ Days:** Delinquent balances for audit or write-off review.

Collecting an Outstanding Balance

1. Navigate to **Billing › Outstanding**.
2. Locate the patient's record by searching name, phone number, or invoice number.
3. Click the blue **Take payment** button directly on the row.
4. Enter the collected amount, select payment method, and submit. The invoice status instantly updates to `Paid` when fully cleared.

8. Payments Register & Daily Cashier Reconciliation (`/billing/payments`)

The financial audit ledger tracking every rupee entering or leaving clinic accounts:

TOTAL COLLECTED	TRANSACTIONS	TOTAL REFUNDS	NET COLLECTIONS
₹1,24,850	**286**	**₹3,200**	**₹1,21,650**
Gross receipts in window	Individual payment events	Refund vouchers issued	Net retained revenue

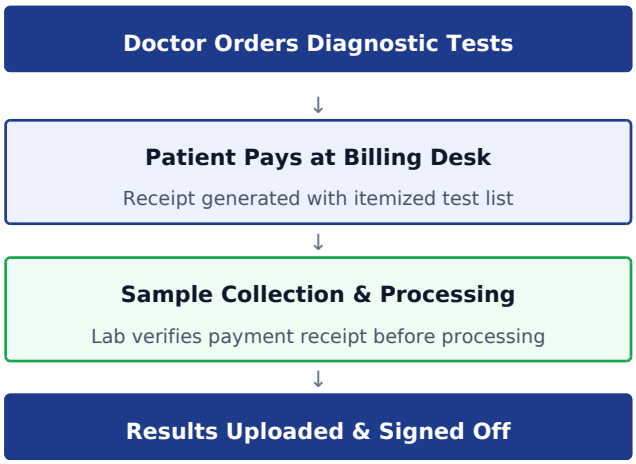
Tender Tabs for Shift & Day-End Close

At the end of every shift or business day, cashiers verify collected tenders using the tender tabs:

Tender Tab	What to Reconcile	Verification Target
Cash	Physical cash inside cashier drawer	Must exactly match physical currency count
UPI	Digital QR payments (PhonePe, GPay, Paytm)	Match against merchant UPI app statement
Card	POS Card swipe machine settlement summary	Match POS machine day-end settlement slip
Bank Transfer	Direct NEFT / IMPS / RTGS credit entries	Match online bank account statement
Other	Cheques, insurance vouchers, demand drafts	Match physical draft slips

9. Laboratory Orders & Billing

FLOW CHART 5 · LAB INVESTIGATION & BILLING LIFECYCLE



Bill generates immediately or upon lab sign-off based on Settings.

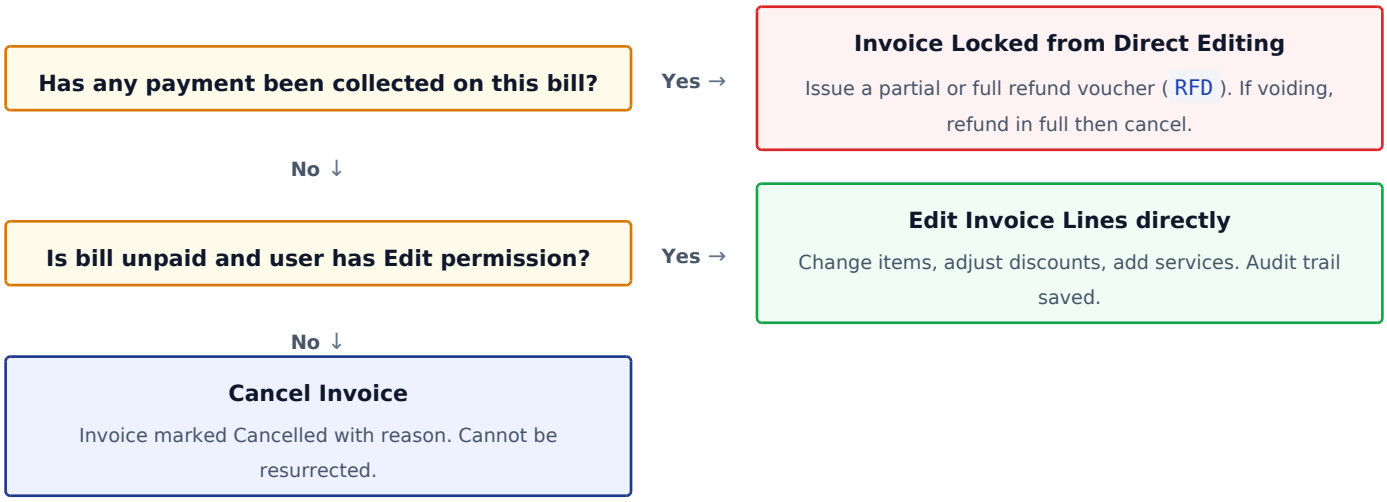
10. Pharmacy Counter Billing & Returns

The pharmacy operates on dedicated POS sales counters with automatic inventory batch allocation:

- **FIFO Batch Allocation:** When medicines are added to a cart, HMS automatically assigns the earliest expiring batch that is in stock.
- **Credit Sales to Registered Patients:** Regular registered patients can be extended credit if enabled in **Pharmacy › Settings**. Walk-in buyers must always pay in full.
- **Medicine Returns:** When a patient returns unopened strips/syrups, click **Take a return** on the pharmacy bill. The returned units automatically increment the correct batch inventory, and a refund or balance credit is issued.

11. Refunds, Corrections & Cancellations

FLOW CHART 6 · DECISION TREE: MODIFYING OR VOIDING A BILL



12. Troubleshooting Guide

Symptom / Message	Root Cause	Action to Fix
"This clinic takes bills in full"	Clinic setting is set to Pay in Full, but cashier entered partial amount.	Collect remaining balance or split across methods (e.g. Cash + UPI).
No "Take payment" button visible	Invoice is already 100% paid, or logged-in user lacks `Record payment` permission.	Check invoice status or ask Admin to update user role permissions.
Doctor fee not appearing on check-in	Doctor profile has ₹0 or empty consultation fee, or billing timing is set to Post-consultation.	Update doctor profile fees in **Doctors** list.
Patient visit stays "Payment Pending"	One department bill (OPD, Lab, or Pharmacy) still carries an outstanding balance.	Open **Billing › Outstanding** to identify and clear the unpaid bill.
Cannot edit invoice items	A receipt has already been generated against this invoice.	Issue a refund voucher first, or cancel after full refund.

Symptom / Message	Root Cause	Action to Fix
Cash drawer does not tally with system	Cashier collected cash but recorded as UPI, or gave cash change without recording.	Filter **Billing › Payments** by **Cash** to identify discrepancies.

13. Screen Navigation & Quick Directory

What you want to do	Go to Menu	Shortcut / Action
View clinic financial overview & trends	**Billing › Dashboard**	KPIs, Analytics, Invoices
Find all outstanding unpaid bills	**Billing › Outstanding**	Aging buckets & Take payment
Audit individual receipts & tender breakdown	**Billing › Payments**	Cash, UPI, Card tabs
Search and filter all invoices	**Billing › Invoices**	Full search & Export
Configure doctor fees & service charges	**Billing › Services & prices**	Branch-specific pricing
Configure document prefixes & rules	**Settings › Billing**	Series, GST %, Rules
Dispense medicines & pharmacy billing	**Pharmacy › Sales (POS)**	Counter checkout
Process medicine returns	**Pharmacy › Bills**	Open bill → Take a return
Manage staff billing permissions	**Roles & Permissions**	Permissions → Billing
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